

# Is ChatGPT lying about electricity consumption? It says spend same energy per inquiry like google search

Posted by u/cejno • 0 points • 4 comments

Yep — for 1,000 questions, we can compare using the best-known published per-query estimates (they vary a lot, so I'll show ranges).

Electricity for 1,000 inquiries (Wh and kWh)

What this means

- Using newer estimates, 1,000 ChatGPT questions is roughly about the same electricity as 1,000 Google searches (both around 0.3 kWh) [OBJ]
- Using the older “10×” estimate, ChatGPT could be ~10× higher (2.9 kWh vs 0.3 kWh) [OBJ]

If you tell me which comparison you want to treat as “official” (modern typical vs older 10× claim), I can also convert these into cost (MXN/USD) using a typical electricity rate.

## Comments

u/Popular\_Lab5573 • 1 points • 2025-12-17 01:25 UTC

you didn't bother to check the resources it used and rushed to post this on reddit? jeez

u/eras • 3 points • 2025-12-16 08:01 UTC

It seems to link to some sources that have that information. It wouldn't really know how much energy it uses unless someone tells it this information.

And even then it might get it wrong.

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-12-16 05:36 UTC

Hey /u/cejno!

If your post is a screenshot of a ChatGPT conversation, please reply to this message with the [conversation link](<https://help.openai.com/en/articles/7925741-chatgpt-shared-links-faq>) or prompt.

If your post is a DALL-E 3 image post, please reply with the prompt used to make this image.

Consider joining our [public discord server](<https://discord.gg/r-chatgpt-1050422060352024636>)! We have free bots with GPT-4 (with vision), image generators, and more!

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Note: For any ChatGPT-related concerns, email [support@openai.com](mailto:support@openai.com)

\*I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit](/message/compose/?to=/r/ChatGPT) if you have any questions or concerns.\*

**u/cejno** • 1 points • 2025-12-16 05:39 UTC

[https://chatgpt.com/s/t\\_6940f04d7dec81918e7b84e6d07ed710](https://chatgpt.com/s/t_6940f04d7dec81918e7b84e6d07ed710)